

YEONGMI JEONG

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Employment

Postdoctoral Research Associate, Department of Sociology, Purdue University, 2023-Present
Research Assistant, National Bureau of Economic Research (NBER), Summer 2022

Education

Ph.D.

Economics, University of Georgia, 2018-2023

M.S.

Computer Science, Georgia Institute of Technology, 2023-Present
Statistics, University of Georgia, 2023

M.A.

Economics, Seoul National University, 2014-2017

B.A.

Economics, *Summa Cum Laude*, Hongik University, 2010-2014

Visiting Student Program

University of North Carolina at Charlotte, 2012

Research Fields

Health Economics, Social Science Genetics, Labor Economics, Applied Microeconomics

Brief Bio

Dr. Yeongmi Jeong, a post-doctoral research associate in the Department of Sociology at Purdue University, is an applied microeconomist with a strong interdisciplinary focus spanning health economics, social science genetics, and education. Her research focuses on utilizing recent advances in genomic science to investigate the complex relationships between individuals' genetic markers and their health and economic outcomes, with a particular emphasis on conditions such as Alzheimer's Disease, smoking behavior, and depression. She also conducts research evaluating the effects of public policies—especially those related to working conditions, tobacco control, and substance use—on health and socioeconomic outcomes. Moreover, Dr. Jeong is engaged in research at the intersection of science education and social equity. Her recent work examines the effectiveness of humane genetics education in reducing genetic essentialism among college students.

Economics

Publications

"The Effect of Peers' Genetic Predisposition to Depression on Own Mental Health", *Journal of Health Economics*, Volume 104, Article 103053, December 2025.

Working Papers

“Genetic Risk for Alzheimer’s Disease and Related Dementias: Cognition, Economic Behavior, and Clinically Actionable Information” (2025) with Nicholas Papageorge, Meghan Skira, and Kevin Thom, *Submitted*.

“The Complicated Links between Genetic Endowments for Smoking and Health” (2025) with Meghan Skira and Robbee Wedow.

“Taxing Addiction in Hard Times: Cigarette Taxes and Smoking During Recessions” (2025) with Yichu Li, Heran Chung, Xiaolong (Chris) Hou

“The Mental Health Effects of Reduced Working Hours: Evidence from South Korea” (2025) with Hyun Ju Kim , Taehyun Kim , Hansoo Ko

Research in Progress

“Spousal BMI and Mental Health: An Instrumental Variables Approach” with Xiaolong (Chris) Hou, Yichu Li, Kaiyi Wen, Zhuo Chen

“The Effect of Smoking on Spousal Smoking: Using Genetic IV” with Xiaolong (Chris) Hou and Keshob Sharma.

“The Effects of Outdoor Smoking Bans on Smoking, Secondhand Smoke Exposure, and Health: Evidence from South Korea”

“The Effect of Tobacco 21 Laws on Prenatal Smoking, Infant Mortality, and Birth Outcomes”

Social Science Genetics

Publications

“How and for whom can genetics education reduce beliefs in genetic essentialism?” with Robbee Wedow, Katherine N. Thompson, Kathryn Fiuza Malerbi, Andrew Brubaker, Monica Weindling, Stanley M. Lo, Jamie Amemiya, and Brian M. Donovan, *Human Genetics and Genomics Advances*, Volume 7, Issue 1, 15 January 2026.

Working Papers

“Developing and Teaching Curriculum to Reduce Genetic Essentialism in College Classrooms” (2025) with Kathryn Fiuza Malerbi, Andrew Brubaker, Monica Weindling, Katherine N. Thompson, Christine Miriam Habib, Brian M. Donovan, and Robbee Wedow, *Revise and Resubmit* at Behavioral Genetics

“Are Social Support Interventions an Avenue to Reduce Disparities in Depression Symptoms? Applying the Health Disparity Framework in a Representative US Longitudinal Cohort” (2025) with Katherine Thompson, Evelina Akimova, Geyu Zhou, Erin Dunn, Elisabeth Noland, Moritz Herle, Robbee Wedow, *Pre-registration* at European Neuropsychopharmacology

“Genome-wide association study of adolescent-onset depression” (2025) with Poppy Z Grimes, Britany L Mitchell, Katherine N Thompson, Qingkun Deng, ..., Yi Lu, Heather C Whalley, Alex SF Kwong, *Preprint* at medRxiv

“Illuminating the complex interplay of risk factors for depression within a large-scale US longitudinal cohort” (2024) with Katherine Nina Thompson, Baptiste Couvy-Duchesne, Sang Hong Lee, Rafael Georgas, Saranya Arirangan, Saul Newman, Robbee Wedow, Felix C Tropf

Research in Progress

“Gene-by-environment interactions in smoking: Insights from human genetics” with Robbee Wedow, Michel Nivard, Andrea Ganna, Brad Verhulst

Awards, Fellowships, and Grants

Genomics for Social Scientists (GeSS) Workshop Travel Grant, University of Michigan, 2024
Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award, University of Georgia, 2023
Graduate School Student Travel Grant, University of Georgia, 2022
Swift Undergraduate Teaching Fellowship Award, University of Georgia, 2022
Add Health Users Conference Travel Grant, 2022
NBER Center for Aging and Health Pilot Award, 2021-2022
Bonbright Graduate Student Research Grant, University of Georgia, 2021
Graduate Assistantship, University of Georgia, 2018-2023
BK 21 Graduate Student Research Fellowship, National Research Foundation of Korea, 2014-2017

Conference/Seminar Presentations & Workshops

2025

Behavior Genetics Association (BGA) Annual Meeting; Stanford Center for Biomedical Ethics

2024

Southern Economic Association (SEA) Meetings; International Statistical Genetic (ISG) Workshop for *Human Complex Traits: The Latent Genetics Course*; Genomics for Social Scientists (GeSS) Workshop – *Introduction*

2023

Allied Social Sciences Associations (ASSA) Annual Meeting; Frontiers in Economic Analysis with Genetic Data; The Advances in Social Genomics Conference Series (TAGC); American Society of Health Economists (ASHEcon) Conference; Center to Accelerate Population Research in Alzheimer’s and National Bureau of Economic Research (CAPRA-NBER) Scientific Meeting; Association for Public Policy Analysis and Management (APPAM) Fall Research Conference

2022

Southern Economic Association (SEA) Meetings; Add Health Data Users Conference

2021

CSWEP “Successfully Navigating Your Economics PhD” Mentoring Workshop

Professional Activities

Journal Referee

Journal of Health Economics

Teaching Experience

Instructor

Principles of Microeconomics (Undergraduate), University of Georgia, Spring 2021

Teaching Evaluation: 4.5/5

Teaching Assistant

Economic Growth and Development (Undergraduate), University of Georgia, Fall 2019

Intermediate Macroeconomics (Undergraduate), University of Georgia, Fall 2019

International Trade (Undergraduate), University of Georgia, Spring 2019

Health Economics (Undergraduate), University of Georgia, Fall 2018 and Spring 2019

Economics of Human Resources (Undergraduate), University of Georgia, Fall 2018

Econometrics (Undergraduate), Seoul National University, Fall 2016

Studies in Econometrics (Graduate), Seoul National University, Fall 2015 and 2017

Mentoring/Advising

Mentoring (including current position)

Kathryn Malerbi (2026; Lab Manager at WedowLab)

Certifications

International Statistical Genetic Workshop for Human Complex Traits: The Latent Genetics Course,
University of Colorado, 2024

Workforce Diversity Certificate, Terry College of Business, University of Georgia, 2022

Certificate in Diversity and Inclusion, Office of Institutional Diversity, University of Georgia, 2022

Computer Skills

Stata, R, Git, and Unix/Linux shell commands

Nationality and Language

Nationality

Republic of Korea (South Korea)

Languages

Korean (Native), English (Fluent), Spanish (Basic, DELE B1)